

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: It's time to write an important factual e-mail.



Learning Outcome

Explain customs and appropriate behavior at work and in different countries, using a wider range of expressions and formulas.

Can Do Statements

- I can write an e-mail to present evidence and background information.
- I can make comparisons.
- I can talk about jobs and work.

Ask your partner:

- When did you have to deliver bad news to someone? How did you do it?
- Do you think it's better to deliver bad news in person or in an e-mail? Why?





Let's Explore!

Ferdinand provides **comprehensive*** information in an e-mail.

* "Comprehensive" means including everything related to a particular topic.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Subject: Rumor Confirmed
Dear Janet,

This e-mail was not as easy to write as I thought it would be. As you know, we've recently been dealing with some malicious rumors about Holly's, and this situation, as it stands, is going to affect Polygon as well. I'd like to give you an update on the situation and it is as precise as possible while providing a comprehensive background.

As you are already aware, the rumor has been confirmed. It is a fact that Farmani outsources labor to the islands of Tindasia, and his factory is in the city of Shalopolis. The factory meets structure and workplace safety codes as strictly as it would in North America. The investigation indicates that it employs 300 workers a day, about half of whom are children as young as eight years old.

To put things in context, the situation is that the island of Tindasia is not as financially balanced as the other islands in that area. Basically, the poorest come to Shalopolis in the hope of temporary work. By sending their children to work, desperate families hope to survive. Farmani's factory is a legitimate workplace and people receive their promised wages. However, workers' rights are not as respected as one would expect. There are problems with their working conditions. Wages are low and no one has benefits or job security. People line up each morning and receive work on a first-come, first-served basis. Up to now, Farmani has never visited the plant. He appears to have a hands-off approach, trusting various middlemen.

Regards,
Ferdinand.



**Let's Practice!**

Ferdinand makes the evidence clear.

Instructions: Use the phrases from the box to correctly complete each sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

not as easy to write as / as young as / as precise as /
as financially balanced as / as respected as / as strictly as

1. This e-mail was _____ I thought it would be.
2. It is _____ possible while providing a comprehensive background.
3. The factory meets structure and workplace safety codes _____ it would in North America.
4. Half are children _____ eight years old.
5. Workers' rights are not _____ one would expect.
6. The island of Tindasia is not _____ the other islands in that area.

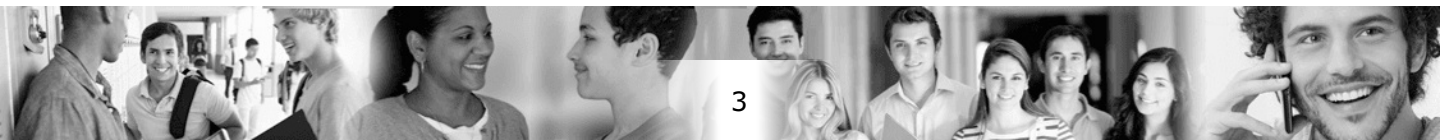
**Let's Practice!**

What are some of the important words Ferdinand used in his e-mail to Janet?

Instructions: Use the words from the box to correctly complete the text.

codes / rumors / precise / middlemen / legitimate / hands-off / benefits /
malicious / hope / employs / security

As you know, we've recently been dealing with some _____ about Holly's. I'd like to give you an update on the situation and it is as _____ as possible. The factory meets structure and workplace safety _____ as strictly as it would in North America. The investigation indicates that it _____ 300 workers a day. Basically, the poorest come to Shalopolis in the hope of temporary work. By sending their children to work, desperate families _____ to survive. Farmani's factory is a _____ workplace. However, workers' rights are not as respected as one would expect. Wages are low and no one has _____ or job _____. Up to now, Farmani has never visited the plant. He appears to have a _____ approach, trusting various _____.





Extension Activity

Compare and contrast two people or things.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose two things you know well enough to compare (eg. two friends, two relatives, two cities, etc.).
- Write 10 sentences comparing the two things that you chose.
- Share your comparison sentences with a partner.

Self-Assessment **Yes** **No**

I make comparisons.

☐ ☐

I write comparisons about two things that I know.

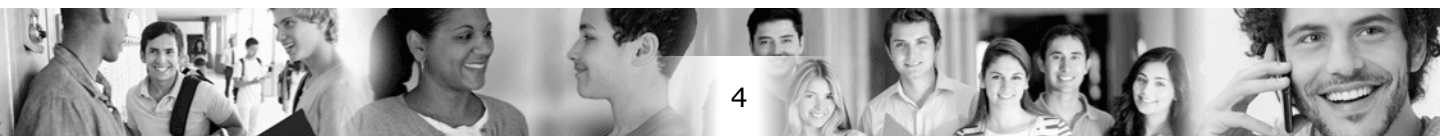
☐ ☐

I read my comparison sentences to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **malicious** (adjective): intentionally hurtful; unkind
e.g. We've recently been dealing with some malicious rumors.
- **precise** (adjective): exact and accurate
e.g. It is as precise as possible while providing a comprehensive background.
- **safety codes** (expression): laws to enforce safety at work
e.g. The factory meets structure and workplace safety codes as strictly as it would in North America.
- **to employ** (verb): to give a job to someone
e.g. The factory employs 300 workers a day.
- **to hope (to)** (verb): to want to be able to do something
e.g. By sending their children to work, desperate families hope to survive.
- **legitimate** (adjective): allowed by law
e.g. Farmani's factory is a legitimate workplace and people receive their promised wages.
- **benefits** (noun): extras, such as dental insurance or a parking space, that an employee may get when working for a company
e.g. Wages are low and no one has benefits or job security.
- **job security** (noun): the belief that your job is likely to be permanent
e.g. Job security is important to everyone.
- **hands-off** (adjective): a style of management that allows other people to make decisions
e.g. He appears to have a hands-off approach, trusting various middlemen.





Learning Points

Making Comparisons

You use *as* + *adjective/adverb* + *as* to compare two things that are the same and *not as* + *adjective/adverb* + *as* to compare two things that are not the same.

We use *as* + *adjective/adverb* + *as* to make comparisons when the things we are talking about two things that are equal in some way.

For example: *It is **as precise as** possible.*

We use *not as* + *adjective/adverb* + *as* to make comparisons between things which aren't equal.

For example: *Tindasia is **not as financially balanced as** the other islands in that area.*

Look at the structure of comparison sentences in the present and past in the table below:

equal present	subject	is looks seems feels works	as + adjective/ adverb + as
not equal present	subject	isn't doesn't look doesn't seem doesn't feel doesn't work	as + adjective/ adverb + as
equal past	subject	was looked seemed felt worked	as + adjective/ adverb + as
not equal past	subject	wasn't didn't look didn't seem didn't feel didn't work	as + adjective/ adverb + as

Examples:

- *This e-mail was not as easy to write as I thought it would be.*





Learning Points

- *It is as precise as possible while providing a comprehensive background.*
- *The factory meets structure and workplace safety codes as strictly as it would in North America.*
- *Half are children as young as eight years old.*
- *Workers' rights are not as respected as one would expect.*

Presenting Evidence and Background Information

You use phrases in your writing to present evidence or proof and give background information.

Business e-mails vary by nature. They can be friendly, personal or neutral. The purpose is almost always to request and provide facts and evidence.

Phrases that you can use to present evidence and give background facts are:

I'd like to give you an update/report/summary.
It is precise/accurate/up-to-date.
As you already know ...
As you are already aware ...
The investigation indicates/shows/proves/reveals ...
To put things in context/into perspective ...

These phrases give validity to your writing and show your reader that you are presenting factual information and not simply opinions.

Examples:

- *I'd like to give you an update on the situation.*
- *It is as precise as possible while providing a comprehensive background.*
- *As you are already aware, the rumour has been confirmed.*
- *The investigation indicates that it employs 300 workers a day.*
- *To put things in context: the situation is that the island of Tindasia is not as financially balanced as the other islands in that area.*

